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Analytical Reasoning-Cause & Effect

Directions (Q.1-18): Below in each question are given two statements (A) and (B). These statements may be either independent causes or may be effects of independent causes or a common cause. One of these statements may be the effect of the other statement. Read both the statements and decide which of the following answer choice correctly depicts the relationship between these two statements.

Mark answer (1) if statement (A) is the cause and statement (B) is its effect.

Mark answer (2) if statement (B) is the cause and statement (A) is its effect.

Mark answer (3) if both the statements (A) and (B) are independent causes.

Mark answer (4) if both the statements (A) and (B) are effects of independent causes.

Mark answer (5) if both the statements (A) and (B) are effects of some common cause.

1. (A) The glaciers at the poles of the earth are melting at a fast rate.

(B) In recent times there has been a substantial increase in the incidents of earthquakes and volcanic eruptions.

Ans. (4)

Clearly, both the statements (A) and (B) are effects of independent causes.

2. (A) Most of the shopkeepers in the locality closed their shops for the second continuous day.

(B) Two groups of people living in the locality have been fighting with each other with bricks and stones forcing people to stay indoors.

Ans. (2)

Clearly statement (B) is the cause and statement (A) is its effect.

3. (A) The Government has decided to increase the prices of LPG gas cylinders with immediate effect.

(B) The Government has decided to increase the prices of kerosene with immediate effect.

Ans. (5)

Both the statements (A) and (B) are effects of some common cause.

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4. (A) There have been several incidences of air mishaps across the world which have exposed gaps in air safety measures.

(B) The international transportation safety board has proposed to conduct an emergency inspection of international airports and airlines in many countries.

Ans. (1)

Obviously, statement (A) is the cause and statement (B) is its effect.

5. (A) A majority of students performed poorly during board exams this year.

(B) Teachers and the administrative staff have threatened to go on a strike demanding a raise in their salary packages.

Ans. (4)

Clearly, both the statements (A) and (B) are effects of independent causes.

6. (A) The government has formed a task force to prevent illegal felling of trees in several parts of the country.

(B) The government has levied severe penalty on the industries polluting nearby land and water bodies to protect the environment.

Ans. (5)

Clearly, both the statements (A) and (B) are effects of some common cause.

7. (A) Many scientists have indicated that extreme stress situations at the workplace lead to various disorders ranging from diabetes to heart ailments.

(B) In a major research the scientists have proven that Indian population is more susceptible to heart ailments owing to their genetic makeup.

Ans. (4)

Clearly, both the statements (A) and (B) are effects of independent causes.

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8. (A) Many farmers have reverted to using traditional methods of agriculture from the ones utilizing genetically modified seeds.

(B) Many farmers using genetically modified seeds have been experiencing a significant decline in soil fertility.

Ans. (2)

Clearly, statement (B) is the cause and statement (A) is its effect.

9. (A) The temperature of the city was the lowest during the week. The city recorded low temperature of the decade. The city was also engulfed in fog.

(B) There was unusual delay in the flights from the city and so passengers were stranded at the airport. The passengers faced many problems at the airport.

Ans. (1)

Obviously, statement (A) is the cause and statement (B) is its effect.

10. (A) The roads of City A get flooded with vehicles during the evening hour and major parts of city face the problem of traffic jam.

(B) The level of air pollution has been increased in the City A these days.

Ans. (1)

Obviously, statement (A) is the cause and statement (B) is its effect.

11. (A) Many seats in the private engineering colleges in the state have remained vacant this year.

(B) The government engineering colleges in the state could accommodate all the students who sought admission this year.

Ans. (4)

According to question, both the statements (A) and (B) are effects of independent causes.

12. (A) The government of India has allowed the private airline companies to operate in specified international routes.



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(B) There has been a considerable increase in the flow of foreign tourists to India.

Ans. (1)

According to question, (A) is the cause and statement (B) is its effect.

13. (A) The state government has now decided to increase the stamp duty on house purchases with immediate effect.

(B) The real estate prices have decreased considerably during the last few months.

Ans. (2)

According to question, statement (B) is the cause and statement (A) is its effect.

Due to slump in real estate, the revenue generation has decreased and to meet the target revenue generation from stamp duty, the government has decided this.

14. (A) Most of the steel manufacturing companies in the country have made considerable profit during the last financial year.

(B) Many Asian countries have been importing huge quantities of steel from India.

Ans. (2)

According to question, statement (B) is the cause and statement (A) is its effect.

15. (A) The bank decided to give advances to the priority sector at the rate of interest at par with the corporate sector.

(B) The percentage of bad loans given by the banks to the priority sector is very low compared to corporate sector.

Ans. (3)

According to the question, both the statements (A) and (B) are independent causes.

16. (A) The department store owner put cameras for surveillance of the store.

(B) Many products were reported missing by the staff working in the department store.

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Ans. (2)

Statement (B) is the cause and statement (A) is its effect.

17. (A) Lung cancer is the most hazardous disease in India. It is not necessarily caused due to smoking rather passive smoking is more dangerous.

(B) Government has banned smoking in public and it has been made a punishable offence.

Ans. (1)

Obviously, statement (A) is the cause and statement (B) is its effect.

18. (1) The association of management colleges conducted a combined admission exam for all the institutes this year.

(2) As the dates for entrance exam for many management colleges clashed last year, many candidates complained that they could not appear for a number of entrance exams.

Ans. (2)

Statement (B) is the cause and statement (A) is its effect.

19. Effect: This year majority of the final year students of the management institute have opted for finance specialization.

Which of the following can be a probable cause of the above effect?

(1) Last year most of the students with HR specialization got better job offers than other specializations.

(2) The management institute offers only finance specialization to its final year students.

(3) Last year the students with finance specialization bagged most of the lucrative offers vis-a-vis students with other specializations.

(4) The management institute has recently started its finance specialization in addition to Marketing and HR being offered earlier.

(5) None of these

Ans. (3)



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Last year the students with finance specialization bagged most of the lucrative offers vis-a-vis students with other specializations.

20. **Cause:** All the major rivers in the state have been flowing way over the danger level for the past few weeks.

Which of the following is/are possible effect(s) of the above cause?

- (A) Many villages situated near the river banks are submerged forcing residents to flee.
- (B) Government has decided to provide alternate shelter to all the affected villagers residing near the river banks.
- (C) The entire state has been put on high flood alert.

- (1) Only (A)
- (2) Only (A) and (B)
- (3) Only (B) and (C)
- (4) All (A), (B) and (C)
- (5) None of these

Ans. (4)

All (A), (B) and (C)

21. Study the following information to answer the given question.

Company S has recently rented many apartments in building Y for providing official quarters to its employees. However, although many employees had requested the company to provide accommodation around six months ago, since the announcement of quarters last month, hardly any employees has signed up for the new facility.

Which of the following may not be a reason for the employees unwillingness to live in the official quarters?

- (1) All the employees of company S were informed just two months ago that the company had decided to triple the house rent allowance (HRA) shortly.
- (2) The area where the company has rented the apartments does not have a school, college or hospital in its 3 km radius.
- (3) The maintenance amount for the apartments which have been rented by the company is very high and the company has announced that employees would have to pay the amount on their own.

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(4) There have been talks about the company changing its office location is very far from the area in which the apartments have been rented.

(5) Apartments which have been rented by the company area located at an area which does not have adequate public transport facilities.

Ans. (4)

All the options appear appropriate reasons to decline the offer by the company S at a glance. However, critical analysis of all the options reveals that option (4) is an uncertain event. Therefore, it may not be a reason for the employee's unwillingness to live in the official quarters.

22. Read the following information carefully to answer the given question.

A few days after the semester results of a private Commerce College were declared, all the professors of the college went on a strike.

Which of the following may be a reason behind the professors going on strike?

(1) A few new professors were appointed last year at an equal salary even though they were not as qualified as others.

(2) None of the professors were allowed to be external examiner for other affiliated colleges this time.

(3) For the third time in a row, the teachers were blamed for low results despite their consistent efforts.

(4) The salaries of the professors have not been increased since the past two years.

(5) The result declaration was delayed by over a week for this semester.

Ans. (3)

All the professors of the Commerce College went on a strike after the results were declared. Therefore, option (3) could be a reason for the strike.

23. Read the following information and answer the given question.

Despite severe power shortage and regular power cuts, the Government of X has refused to buy power from ABC Power Company, a private company in the same state.

Which of the following may be a reason due to which the Government of State X has denied buying power from the said company?

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- (1) At present State X buys power from a neighbouring State-State Y.
- (2) Company ABC is a fairly new company and does not have the experience of handling a project efficiently.
- (3) The government of State X is planning to open its own power plant in a period of five years in order to install sufficient power capacity.
- (4) Although Company ABC has quoted a little higher price than expected, it has assured the Government that the state will receive uninterrupted power throughout the day and night.
- (5) Many people in State X have become habituated to the power cuts and as a result hardly anyone complains about the same.

Ans. (2)

Obviously option (2) may be the reason.

24. Read the following information carefully and answer the questions given below:

Exports of tea by Country X to Country Z, a major importer of tea from Country X, were reduced by more than half in the present year as compared to previous year even though the production of tea in country X was increased by 25% in the said year.

Which of the following statements cannot be a reason for the given problem?

- (1) Until last year, tea was exempt from export duty in Country X but this year the government levied the export duty of Rs. 10 per kg.
- (2) Country Z signed agreement with three new countries which provide good quality tea at comparatively much lower prices than Country X.
- (3) Many harmful chemicals were reportedly found in the tea of Country X upon being tested by Country Z last year.
- (4) The market price of tea was reduced by 5% for consecutive two years by Country X for its foreign buyers.
- (5) Tea producers of Country X started using a new type of fertiliser in the last year which promised good production but at the cost of quality.

Ans. (4)

Obviously, option (4) may not be the reason for reduction in the exports of tea to country Z from country X.

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25. 'People travelling in City X have to face heavy traffic during the peak hours which causes them delay and other such difficulties.' - A survey.

Which of the following may be a reason for poor traffic conditions in City X?

(A) The number of vehicles on the road of City X has increased substantially with a growth in the purchasing power of the people of City X over a passage of time.

(B) The scope of finding open spaces for parking has reduced remarkably over the last few years due to increased population of the city and this has led to unauthorized parking by the road sides.

(C) The State Government has announced flexi timings policy for all Government offices of the state.

(1) Both (A) and (B)

(2) Both (B) and (C)

(1) Only (A)

(1) Both (A) and (C)

(1) Only (B)

Ans. (1)

Obviously, Statements (A) and (B) are reasons for the poor traffic conditions in the City X, Statement (C) is a measure to solve the problem of heavy traffic.